
The Odd

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Abstract

Welcome another *Into the Odd* hack that is tuned for the Realm of The Odd, a patch of land around a lake, that until recently had exactly zero mountains in the middle of it. With the addition of Magic, Injuries, and Quirks, it became its own system that deserves its own little rulebook. Great inspirations are taken from *Mythic Bastionland*, *Tales from Elsewhere*, *Blades in the Dark*, *Daggerheart* and *Darkest Dungeon*.

Life in the Realm of The Odd

TODO: describe things that are well known about this realm.

Getting Started

Find a Referee, create a knight, decide if they are a mage, a witch, or neither, and go for it.

Dice Rolls

To resolve some events, a roll is needed. Two mechanics modify the roll itself or the dice in the roll.

Upface & Downface. Certain abilities can Upface and Downface a die. To Upface a die, find it in the sequence:

d1, d4, d6, d8, d12

And replace it with the next one. To Downface a die, replace it with the previous one. d1 can't be Downfaced and d12 can't be Upfaced.

You probably don't have a d1 in your possession, but as it always rolls 1, you can use any small object to represent it.

When you are Upfacing or Downfacing a die in an Attack roll, do that before declaring Focus usage.

Repeated advantage & disadvantage. There are several types of rolls: attack roll, Virtue Saves, Spellweaving Roll, and more. Some of them, including the named three, can be rolled with Advantage or Disadvantage.

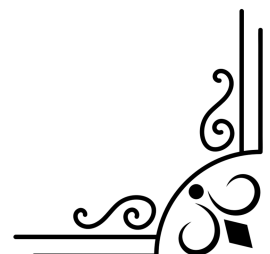
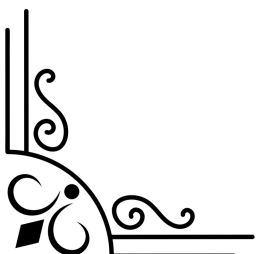
To roll with Advantage, add a copy of a die that already exists in the roll. Perform a roll and then remove a die that shares the number of faces with the added one. Typically, you want to remove the lowest one, but ultimately it's for you to decide which one to remove.

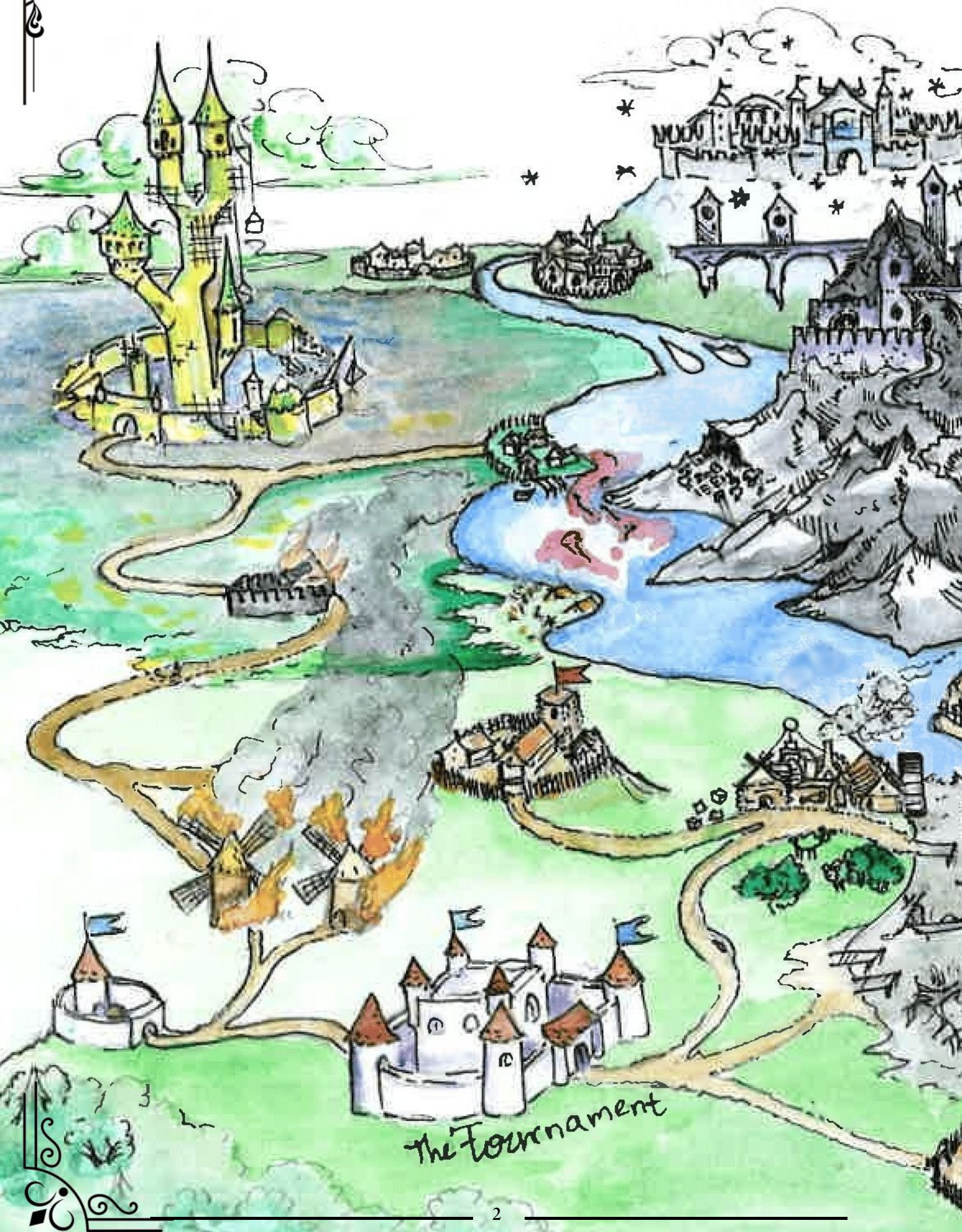
It is possible to roll with repeated Advantage by adding and then removing corresponding number of dice copies.

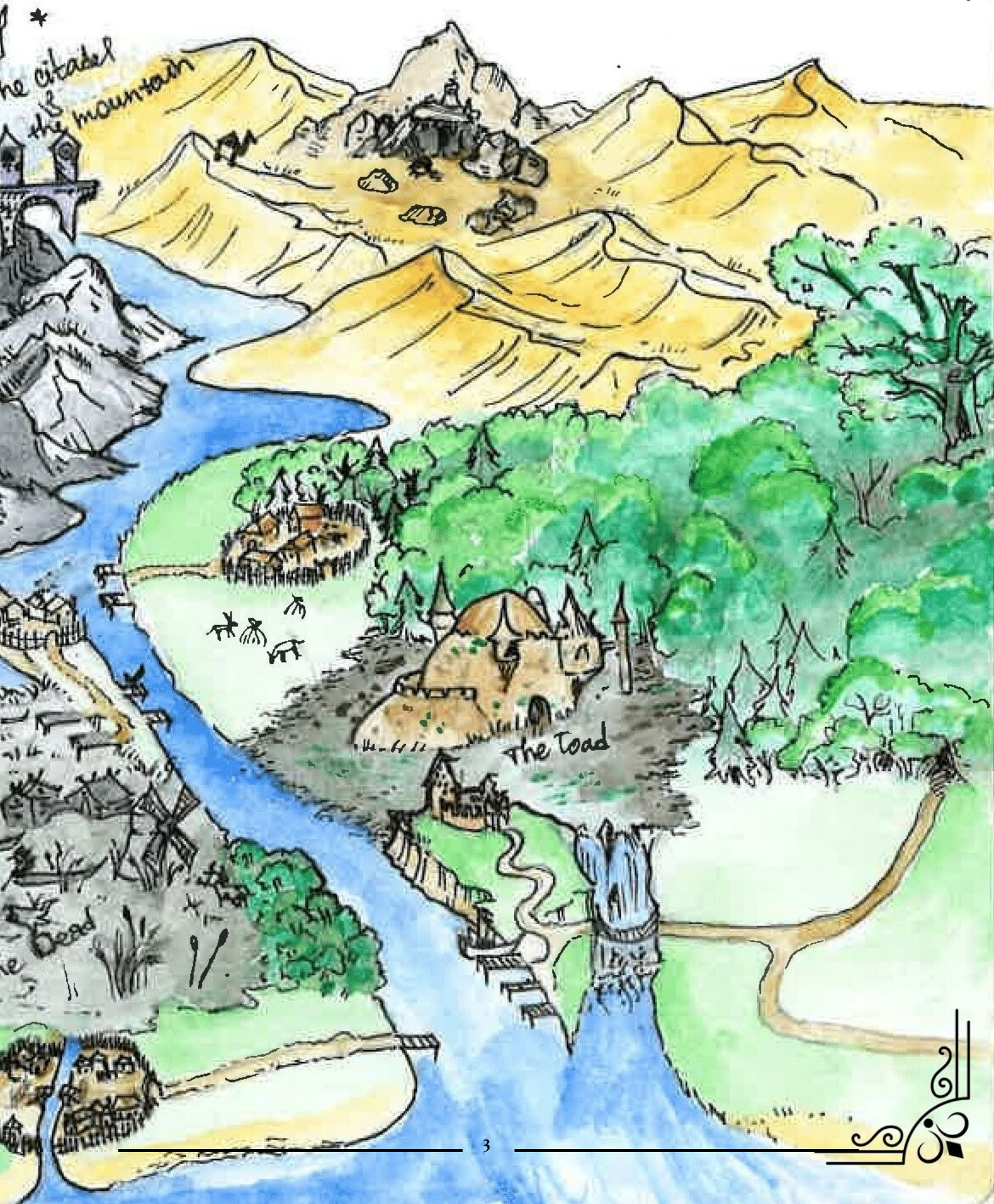
To roll with Disadvantage – do the same, but you must remove the best one (the least one for Virtue Checks, the highest for Attack Rolls) from the roll.

If there is a need to simultaneously roll with Advantage and Disadvantage, remove matching pairs of "-antages" until only one of them remains.

It is possible to add (Dis) Advantage to rolls after the roll is performed. To do that, choose a die that is present there and roll its copy. Then proceed as if they were rolled together.







Creating a Knight

Virtues

Each knight has three attributes that describe his body, mind, and soul.

Vigor. Strong limbs, firm hands, powerful lungs.

Clarity. Keen instinct, lucid mind, shrewd eyes.

Spirit. Charming tongue, iron will, fierce heart.

Knight's creation starts by rolling d6 + d12 four times; record not only the sum, but also individual values of each die. Each of those rolls determines one of the knight's Virtues; you choose which is which and discard the remaining one. You can use character sheet on page 5.

Then, determine the knight's capacity for Injury(Injury Slots), Focus and Stress according to steps below.

♥ Half, rounded up, of d12 you assigned to Vigor is the amount of Severe Injuries the knight can survive before dying.

† Half, rounded up, of d6 you assigned to Vigor is the amount of Lethal Injuries the knight can survive before dying.

* The value of d6 you assigned to Clarity is maximum Focus the knight has.

❖ Half, rounded up, of d12 you assigned to Spirit is maximum Stress the knight can endure before suffering a Trauma, minimum is 2.

Guard. Roll d6 to determine the maximum Guard(GD) the knight has.

Choose a Passion. Something dear to the knight's heart, or something weird that allows them to shrug off a failure. Indulging a Passion restores Spirit and Spellweaving dice (p.12). Consult with your Referee if in doubt.

Saves. To pass a Save, roll a d20 equal or below the relevant Virtue. Failure means negative consequences, not always a failed action.

Feats. Knight knows all three Feats: Smite, Focus and Deny. They can perform them during combat, details of which are on page 7.

Injury Slots

When knight suffers an Injury – fill an Injury slot following steps described below.

1. Determine if injury is Severe or Lethal
2. Briefly describe an injury
3. Record the damage die of the attack which caused the injury
4. Roll Affliction(see p.8) and record it

Each injury could be:

- **Untreated** injury applies Affliction
- **Treated**(see p. 23) injury occupies the slot, but does not apply Affliction
- **Healed** injury is removed entirely, but leaves a Quirk(see p.11).

If a knight suffers an injury and all corresponding slots are full – fill one with greater lethality. If they are out of those, the knight is **Slain**.

Spellcasting

The Realm is not strange to magic and, though not frequently, knights employ it during their endeavours. Some knights are **Spellweavers**(see p.12) and some are **Witches**(see p.14).

Weapons & Gear

When picking gear for a knight consult with the Referee, but the rule of thumb is as follows: you have budget of 12 points, these points can be spent on weapons and armour.

Weapon costs as much as its damage dice. For example, shortsword(2d6 damage) costs 12 points, knife(d6 damage) - 6 points. Each gear providing armour costs 2 per armour point, e.g. shield costs 6 points. Usually it makes sense to limit the starting equipment(p. 20) to be common rarity with a single uncommon item as a prized possession of your knight.

Name: _____

Armour

Weapons & Gear

Vigor

Guard

Lethal
8 or all



Severe
4 or half

Scar if unchanged

Clarity

Focus



Severe
4 or half

Spirit

Stress



Severe
4 or half

Fatigue



Severe
4 or half

Quirks & Malady

Ability

Witchcraft

Patron passion & Boons

Favours

Severe Injuries

	Treated	Injury:
	Damage	
	Die	

	Treated	Injury:
	Damage	
	Die	

	Treated	Injury:
	Damage	
	Die	

	Treated	Injury:
	Damage	
	Die	

	Treated	Injury:
	Damage	
	Die	

	Treated	Injury:
	Damage	
	Die	

	Treated	Injury:
	Damage	
	Die	

	Treated	Injury:
	Damage	
	Die	

	Treated	Injury:
	Damage	
	Die	

Spellweaving Pool

Spellweaving

Spells

Lethal Injuries

	Treated	Injury:
	Damage	
	Die	

	Treated	Injury:
	Damage	
	Die	

	Treated	Injury:
	Damage	
	Die	

Basic Rules

Focus & Stress

There are two important resources each knight has: the amount of thought they can put into perfecting a task and the amount of effort they can put into a failed task to fix it. Those are tracked by Focus and Stress respectively.

Focus. When a roll is performed that can be affected by a character, they can spend Focus to enhance it. It **must** be declared **before** rolling the dice. For each point of Focus spent – add Advantage to that roll.

One can not only plot how to enhance the roll, but also how to sabotage a roll. If one character can affect the roll of another destructively by planning in advance, for each Focus spent, the roll accumulates Disadvantage. *Defense* governs this interaction for the attack rolls, see below.

Usually, a knight has no restriction on how much Focus they can spend to enhance an action, but determining how much focus is possible to spend to oppose a given action should be discussed with the Referee.

The order is important, so opposing characters decide how much Focus they spend simultaneously.

Stress. After a roll is made, a knight can decide that they are not satisfied with the result and try to fix it by acquiring Stress. For each gained Stress, add Advantage to that roll. Increasing one's Stress **must** be done **after** the roll.

Similar to Focus, one can also acquire Stress to oppose an action reactively – after the roll is made.

Dealing with an explicit incoming danger – any amount of Stress can be spent. For split second reaction, like avoiding sudden fall or dodging an arrow – up to 1 Stress can be spent.

Opposing characters decide how much Stress they spend simultaneously.

A character can't spend Stress if they are at maximum Stress. After resolving an action, check if your Stress is at maximum. If it is, set it to zero and the character suffers a Trauma(p.8).

Attacks

Turns. A turn is enough time to Move and then perform an Action always in that order.

To attack – take the Weapon Dice noted on your weapon(s), shield, and granted by bonuses and go through the steps below.

1. Declare and spend Focus, if target allocated any Focus for its defense – they may spend it. Remove matching (Dis)Advantages.
2. Those attacking the same target roll at the same time. Don't mix the dice: Focus and Stress applies individually.
3. Remove extra dice added through Focus.
4. Declare Stress gain. Target declares their Stress gain. Remove matching (Dis)Advantages and roll added dice.
5. Remove extra dice from Stress.
6. Now you can mix all dice and declare which one is used as a damage die and which are spent on Gambits.
7. If the target or their nearby allies can Deny, they may use it.
8. Resolve Gambits that may result in more damage dice(e.g. Dismount).
9. If the damage die is discarded – assign a new one, possibly cancelling a Gambit. Other Gambit allocations can't change.
10. Add any extra Damage from attackers who are Bolstering the Attack.
11. Subtract the target's total Armour score.
12. The Attack causes that much Damage.
13. Resolve non-damaging Gambits.

Impaired attacks roll d4 only and cannot gain bonus dice or benefit from Feats.

Blast attacks target everybody in their area, rolling each separately.

Defense is declared at the end of the turn. Allocate any amount of Focus, when you are attacked next turn – you can spend any amount allocated to apply Disadvantage to the attack. In the end of that turn mark all Focus allocated for the defense as spent.

Combat

Damage

The attack's Damage is split between the target's Guard and their Vigor at the target's discretion; both are reduced by the respective amount.

If their Vigor is unchanged – they evade the Attack.

If damage overflows into their Vigor – they are Wounded.

Check if Damage to Vigor causes a Scar or an Injury, see p.8.

If it does cause an Injury – fill the Injury slot, record damage die that dealt it and apply Affliction, also see p.8.

If a knight is injured and has no required injury slot left, they are **Slain**.

Virtue loss.

Victims are only **Slain**, Wounded or Injured if the Virtue was reduced by Damage, never as a result of *Virtue Loss*.

At 0 Vigor you are Exhausted and cannot Attack if you have moved this turn.

At 0 Clarity you are Exposed and treated as having 0 Guard.

At 0 Spirit your attacks are Impaired.

Feats

These special actions known by knights can be performed as described below. Using Feats risks the knight becoming Fatigued which prevents them from using further Feats until they rest.

Smite. *Release your righteous fury*

- Use before rolling a melee Attack.
- The Attack gains either +1d12 or Blast.
- Pass Vigor save or become Fatigued.

Focus. *Create an opening to exploit*

- Use after rolling an Attack.
- Perform a Gambit without using a die.
- Pass Clarity save or become Fatigued.

Deny. *Rebuff an attack before it lands*

- Use after an Attack roll against you or an ally within arm's reach.
- Discard one Attack die from the roll.
- Pass Spirit save or become Fatigued.

Gambits

Attackers can discard any number of dice in Attack Roll with value 4 or higher to perform Gambits, each one causing one of the effects below. The affected foe must be the same as the target of the attack, except for Makeshift treatment Gambit.

For gambits other than Bolster, Move and Makeshift treatment, the target receives a Vigor Save to ignore the effect.

- **Bolster** the Attack for +1 total Damage
- **Move** after the Attack, even if you already moved or are unable to move
- **Repel** a foe away from you
- **Stop** a foe from moving next turn
- **Impair** a weapon on their next turn
- **Trap** a shield until your next turn
- **Dismount** a foe (add d6 to damage dice)
- **Step back** keeping defense up (+1 GD)
- **Makeshift treatment** of your or an ally's injury within arm's reach.
- **Other effect** of a similar level of impact

If a die of 8 or higher is used in melee, then a Strong Gambit is performed, and the attacker chooses one of the following:

- **No Save** is granted to the target
- **Greater effect** such as disarming an item, breaking a wooden shield, or removing a helm. *Bolster* and *Step Back* are not affected.

Makeshift treatment Gambit allows one knight to tend to another one, or one knight to tend to themselves. Tending knight rolls a Clarity Save and the one untended Injury becomes tended. If that save failed the targeted knight must survive the pain of misjudged treatment, by passing a Vigor Save. If this one also fails, the injury is still treated, but increases in lethality, potentially killing the knight.

Death. Even the boldest Knight can die a sudden or ignoble death. Prepare yourself for this. When a Knight dies, the player creates a new Knight, and they are added to the Company as quickly as possible.

Lasting damage

Scars

Each time a knight sustains Damage to Vigor which does not reduce their GD they gain a Scar. Roll the damage die again, add amount of your occupied injury slots and see the table below.

Roll	Scar
1	A lucky escape, Lose d6 Spirit.
2	An old wound opens. One injury becomes untreated again. If your max GD is 2 or less, increase it by d6.
3	A sudden pain demands attention, Lose 1 Focus.
4	Pain drowns the senses, Lose d6 Clarity. If your max GD is 4 or less, increase it by d6.
5	Something wrong on the inside. Gain 1 Stress.
6	Gruesome vision of torn flesh, Lose 2 Focus. If your max GD is 6 or less, increase it by d6.
7	A heavy blow numbs the mind, Lose 2d6 Clarity.
8	Something taken in violent struggle, Gain 2 Stress. When you get patched up, if your max GD is 8 or less, increase it by d6.
9	With a crack, a torturous break, Lose 2d6 Spirit.
10	A limb rendered useless for combat. If your max GD is 10 or less, increase it by d6.
11	Death hunts you. Gain 4 Stress.
12	A most dolorous stroke. When you achieve revenge, if your max GD is 12 or less, increase it by d6.
13+	A spiral of death makes another turn. Gain one Severe Injury.

Injuries

A knight's body is tough and trained since childhood, but it can endure only so much. Dice

that determine a knight's Vigor also control the amount of Severe and Lethal Injuries they can sustain. To track those injuries, use Injury Slots that record the nature of the Injury, the damage die that caused it, and its Affliction.

Damage from the Attack causes at most one Injury, see below, and one more can come from gaining a Scar.

- ♥ If a knight lost 5 or more Vigor through Damage – take a Severe Injury.
- † If a knight lost 10 or more Vigor through Damage – take a Lethal Injury.
- ♥ If a knight lost half or more of their remaining Vigor, but not all of it – take a Severe Injury.
- † If a knight lost all their Vigor or more through Damage – take a Lethal Injury.

Take worse one if two or more apply.

Each untreated injury comes with Affliction according to the table below.

Roll d4	Affliction
1	The cut is deep, you are Bleeding: lose 1 Vigor when your turn starts
2	Pain is unbearable, you are in Agony: lose 1 Clarity when your turn starts
3	Grievous wound, you are in Distress: lose 1 Spirit when your turn starts
4	If this injury is Lethal you blackout until treated

Trauma

When Stress reaches the limit a knight can sustain – it resets and leaves a Trauma behind: a footprint of a great effort in a form a mental wound. Trauma fills an Injury slot and kills a knight by heart attack if they are out of those. It has neither damage die nor Affliction and is dealt with differently(p.10).

Fear & Hope

The battle rages as much on the field as in the warriors head. Extinguishing fear and tending to dwindling hope is as important as finding weaknesses in enemy's armour.

Also its rare that knights fight alone.

Tracking NPC state

Usually, non-player characters(NPCs) and especially those who are not knights, are tracked with less granularity than those controlled by players. And the main stats that is not tracked are Injuries, because its too much bookkeeping and Stress because of its get-out-of-jail nature.

Instead of tracking Injuries, each time an NPC takes Vigor damage that is half, rounding up, of their remaining Vigor – they blackout. They die if left untreated for a while.

Instead of tracking Stress of hostile NPCs Referee uses Fear, and Hope can be used to do the same for knights' allies.

Fear

Each time a knight or a friendly npc rolls 1 on their weapon die or 20 on a Virtue Check the Company accumulates one point of Fear. This is a resource, but it is spent not by knights, but by the Referee.

Any time a hostile NPCs might want to use Stress – Referee can decide that they spent Fear of the Company as if they were gaining Stress. NPCs don't acquire Traumas so its for the Referee to decide how much it is suitable to spend.

Additionally, if knight attempts something risky – it might make sense narratively to manifest their Fear as if they were opposed by some external forces.

Fear is the property of the Company, so it is persistent across passage of time and scenes.

Hope

Each time an enemy of the Company rolls 1 on their weapon die or 20 on a Virtue Check the Company accumulates one point of Hope.

This is a resource, but this time – for the Company. Any player can use Hope points as Focus for themselves or Stress for friendly

NPCs. Spending Hope does not increase Stress and thus can't cause Trauma.

Hope does not persistent across fights and scenes, knights should convert it to Focus for themselves or their NPCs.

Recovery

Breather

Guard requires only a swift moment of safety to recover.

Stress & Focus can also be dealt with quickly, but require consuming **physic**(p. 20). If the knight has no Focus left, they can recover 1 during a breather by acquiring 1 Stress.

Short Rest

It is not enough time to make a fire and cook food, but just right to treat injuries, have a talk, or just zone out to process the latest events.

Focus is restored with decreasing efficiency. Each time a knight rests during the day for an hour they restore Focus, but with various efficiency. The first hour allows a knight to reset their Focus to 4, the second – to 2, and the third one – to 1. Subsequent short rests do not restore Focus. Short rest can't reduce Focus or set it above knight's maximum.

Injuries can be treated during Short Rest without rolls. Knights have basic medical skills to dress and clean wounds. Mark all Injuries as Treated.

Virtue restoration. During a Short Rest it is possible to restore Virtue, provided a knight has required **Remedy**(p. 20).

Overnight Rest

There is no or little hospitality, just a safe place in the forest or nearby ruins. You make a tent, fire and a meal. This is how life is sometimes.

Stress is reduced by 1 each time a knight sleeps full night, **Focus** is restored fully.

Virtues can be restored by 3 points distributed however a knight see fit.

Long Rest

A proper rest in a bed, with a roof overhead and a hot meal in relative safety. No armour is worn, weapons are stored away. You have time to be with yourself or with those around you and forget, at least of a little bit, about all the burdens waiting for you outside.

This takes a night, a day, and another night to have full effect.

A single **Injury** is healed without rolls during a Long Rest. Acquired **Stress** is removed. **Virtues** and **Focus** are restored fully,

Healing

Healing an Injury removes it completely. This is a tricky endeavour which usually requires a professional to accomplish and comes with a price tag.

Still, in dire circumstances, a knight can attempt to heal themselves or another knight:

1. The **healing** knight rolls a **Clarity** check to determine how to treat this type of Injury most effectively.
2. The **healed** knight rolls a **Spirit** check to see if they are able to withstand the pain.

Only if both of the above checks are successful, the knight is healed from the Injury. Any one knight can endure only 1 healing attempt per day.

Getting tougher and acquiring quirks. After suffering through the agony of medicine without painkillers, a knight is relieved from an injury completely.

If the total Guard of a knight is less than the maximum value on a die that is marked on the Injury Slot, roll it and gain that much more.

Free the Injury Slot that was occupied by the healed Injury.

Choose or make the Referee choose a Quirk (p.II) for you that is described below and permanently add it to your knight.

Dealing with Trauma removes it completely. During your sleep pass a **Clarity** check and a **Spirit** check to successfully deal with Trauma. For each point of Stress you have – treat those Virtue checks as if they were opposed with an additional Focus.

Trauma leaves a permanent mark: acquire a Quirk(p.II) as if a knight healed from an Injury.

Quirks

Bloodlust. A visceral reaction to blood fuels strength, but lessens control. You can Upface one die of your weapon if you are Wounded(p.7). However, if somebody is wounded, you can't engage them with nonlethal force.

Desensitized. The things you saw made everything else bleak in comparison; you don't feel much ever since. When you treat an injury on the battlefield, you roll with an additional Focus. However, you can't treat yourself.

Thick-skinned. After you recovered, your skin changed. It became rougher and harder to pierce. You ignore the first Damage to your Vigor per combat if it is not larger than 2. However, when your injury is treated on the battlefield, the roll is treated as if it is opposed with an additional Focus.

High pain tolerance. Your body seems determined to never let you suffer again. You can ignore up to one Agony consequence of your injury. However, each time you roll 20 on a Vigor Save, you lose 1 Vigor.

Masochistic. Pain is unbearable, but somehow it's a good thing. You regain all Focus each time you suffer an Injury. However, don't recover Focus during Short Rest.

Blade obsession. At the beginning of each day, randomly determine a weapon you own that you are obsessed with. You can Upface any die of that weapon. However, each time you strike, you must strike with the weapon you are obsessed with. You can't part with it; during combat it must be in your hand, otherwise at arms length at most.

Gore fascination. You ignore Distress conditions of your Injuries. However, you must treat your Injuries by yourself.

Stressjunkie. Each time you gain Stress, also gain Focus. However, your maximum Stress is halved, rounded up. It can't go lower than 1.

Sadistic. Restore one Focus each time an Attack you participate in reduces both Vigor and Guard. However, gain one Stress when an attack you participate in does not reduce target's Vigor. If this point of Stress would cause Trauma, gain no Stress instead.

Smile like no other. You don't smile a lot, but when you do, people feel what you have been through. You can Downface any die which is used in Attack against you. However, whenever you take a Clarity save during socialization, treat it as if it was opposed with one additional Focus.

Traumatic visions. Each time you swing at your enemy, pain returns. You can keep it at bay, but it takes effort and willpower you don't always have to spare. Each time you roll with Focus you can Upface on die before choosing what die to copy with Focus. However each time you roll without Focus – Downface one die in your roll.

Overconfident. For some reasons, after all the pain, you feel like you have figured it all out. Each time you perform a Feat – gain one Focus after the attack. However, each time you are Fatigued – lose 2 Spirit.

You never learned. Record each time you are Fatigued. Each third time reset the count, resist the Fatigue and gain 2 Stress.

Spellweaving

Weaving a spell

The power of a mage is represented by a Spellweaving Pool: a set of dice that you can use to weave spells.

Spellweaving pool is described by

- Amount and kind of dice it can hold
- How one restores those dice
- What actions, if any, could change it

If several effects grant you a spellweaving pool, those exist independently unless specified. Consuming **Spur** refills 3 dice from any combination of pools.

To weave a spell, a weaver rolls any number of those dice from any available pools as an Action from that set and then decides what to cast. This is a Spellweaving roll. Only one spell can be cast per roll. If the spell does not state otherwise, **Smite Feat** is not applicable for attacks performed within them.

There are many spells one can learn during their mage training, but regardless of syllabus – all spellweavers know *Detect Magic* by heart.

Rethreading of the arcane

When a mage rolls dice to weave a spell, in addition to casting, they can choose half, rounded down, of the remaining dice and discard the rest. These chosen dice can be stored to cast spells later as if they are included in a roll. They persist until spent, and count as in Spellweaving Pool. The amount of dice in the pool, both unused and stored, can't exceed its size.

Becoming a spellweaver

A knight who has been taught spellweaving gets their Spellweaving Pool at character creation. They know any three spells from the list below additionally to *Detect Magic*.

- **Dice** are all d6's and their amount is equal to the value of knight's **Clarity**.
- **Restoring** the pool is done through **Overnight Rest** or indulging a **Passion**, both methods restore 3 of the missing dice.
- **Improving** this pool is challenging, the limit of what could be thought is reached.

Spells

Detect Magic. Pick any number of dice; for each one that rolled its maximum value, you can ask a question about surrounding magic and receive a truthful answer, but the number of words in that answer can't exceed the value rolled on the die. For each other die, the answer is either yes, no, or silence if the question is not applicable. Information for the answer is provided by yourself and spells around you. For example, spells usually are not directly marked by their caster and are not aware of their surroundings beyond the spell's design.

You can learn how a spell unknown to you works. Upon discovery do a **Clarity** check, if successful, ask the Referee if you can learn this spell and, if you can, how many times encountering this spell in the wild is enough.

Heat Metal. Intricate ladder of arcane pulses rapidly heats metal until it glows red hot. Pulses should be chained together carefully; pick no less than three dice with consecutive values. If it is a piece of armour, the wearer takes Damage equal to the sum of chosen dice. If it is a weapon, the bearer chooses to drop it or persevere through pain, taking half of the sum of the chosen dice. Any Damage from this spell ignores Guard.

Magic missile. Identical glowing bolts launch towards chosen targets, piercing bone and muscle. Pick any number of dice with the same value rolled. You can pick a different target for each bolt; it deals Damage equal to the rolled value.

Hex. A curse of misfortune impairs defense and makes the target more vulnerable. Pick three dice that have a value of 1. For the remaining combat, anyone who attacks the bearer of this curse can add a die from the picked ones as an additional weapon die before rolling. The die is not spent and can be used by multiple attackers, but only a single Hex can be cast upon any one creature.

Soothing Visions. Pick two dice both with the same value rolled as the target's Stress. Reduce their Stress by 2.

True Strike. Pick any number of dice, then perform an Attack as usual. You can replace any die of the attack with any die from those you picked. Can be used with Smite Feat.

Shield. Pick two dice and add the smaller rolled value among them to Guard of a willing creature nearby. The shield's Guard is spent before theirs. Shield's Guard persists until their Guard would be restored normally.

Haste. Pick any amount of dice that amount to target's Vigor or greater. Each time a hasted creature attacks, choose a weapon and add its Weapon dice to the Attack one additional time.

Conjure embodiment of magic. Pick up to two dice three times; values for each pick determine virtues of the embodiment. Then pick an additional die – this is its guard. Embodiment obeys your commands and vanishes when any of its virtues reach zero. At dawn of each day you need to maintain it: pick up to two dice; that's the new Vigor of the embodiment. Otherwise, halve each of its virtues, rounding down. Embodiments are unnatural for this world, so at dawn, reduce its Clarity by 2. At the end of each combat, reduce its Spirit by 1. You choose the shape and overall appearance of the embodiment, but it still looks very unnatural and magical for anybody who glances at it. It has no armour, attacks for 2d8, and can use one Feat you choose each morning. It is as intelligent as an orca, can't speak, but comprehends languages you know. Does not really understand human ways, but can mimic them with mixed results.

Witchcraft

Witches cast spells as manifestations of favors granted them by their patrons. Favour is spent after a spell is complete and is regained when a witch indulges the passions of their patrons.

Cantrips don't cost favor, but stop working when a witch has none.

Thaliat, a laughing spirit

Thaliat's passion is of laughter, festival, and theater. She craves stories and tales. Enjoys performances that are done out of pure heart. Treasures celebrations that bring sincere joy for those who participate.

Cantrips

- **Prestidigitation**, a nothing spell. Sparkles, small lights, whispering sounds, change of colour. The more inconsequential something is, the more probable it is a shape of Prestidigitation.
- **Mending**, a minor repair spell. Fixes a tear in fabric, crack in leather, or a snapped thread.

1 Favour spells

- **Last call bell**. You start a dance, a trick or any other performance. As long as you are doing it all doors to the room you are in, except maybe one, close and lock themselves.
- **Curtain drop**. You bow down as if you just ended a performance. Smoke or water mist envelopes you for a few seconds, giving you and up to one other person near you an opportunity to escape combat.
- **Invisible helper**. You summon an invisible, almost immaterial creature that obeys your mental commands. It can move and carry objects that a determined child can, it is easily scared of violence and likes sweets. Disappears when you fall unconscious.
- **Failed Rehearsal**. When you fail a Spirit Save or Clarity Save, you can immediately retry it. Each save can benefit from this spell only once.
- **Disguise Voice**. Make your voice appear as somebody else's whom you heard within at least one conversation.

2 Favour spells

- **Am I here, am I there**. Suddenly it is very hard to understand where you are and what you are doing. Anybody who looks at you feels confused and puzzled, unable to understand your intentions. In combat, it means that for the remainder of it, when you Deny – an additional die of your choice is discarded.
- **Cursed Joke**. You tell your vilest joke and sprinkle enough magic to take it inside the target's head. Upon hearing it, target retracts themselves from any conversation they were having or any activity they were doing. Goes to the corner or seeks solitude if the corner is unavailable and sits there in an increasingly catatonic state. Target falls unconscious after 10 minutes; when woken up, the effect ends. Their memory preserves a feeling of unpleasantness, but the content of the joke vanishes. If the target is in combat, their Attacks are Impaired until the effect ends.

3 Favour spells

- **Let me try one more time**. When you fail a Save targeted by *Failed Rehearsal*, you can retry one more time.
- **All doors are open for me**. Opens any non-magically locked door
- **You are an actor too**. For an hour or until harmed, the target thinks that they are somebody else **they** have a strong impression of. The target acts according to their own understanding of that entity. Upon recovery, they remember vaguely what happened during the effect of this spell.

Vesna, the passage guardian

Deep forest is her domain, where she guards gates between our world and the world of the dead. She seeks to guide those who are stuck in between. Gives her blessings if one helps a scared soul to complete their journey. Cares both for people and animals alike. Despises cruelty and sometimes plays with children, who can still see her. Knows about improper burials and rewards those who make peace with the dead.

Cantrips

- You travel through forests as fast as a horse rider would travel on a road.
- **I help, you provide** You sense local distress of the wilderness. When you resolve it, you can ask for something in return. If it could be found here, it's gonna be provided to you.

1 Favour Spells.

- **Be not afraid.** Talk with animals: they understand you, you understand them.
- **Tell me your story.** Talk with the dead, provided you have something they owned
- **Forest, obscure me.** As long as there is enough foliage around, it shifts to provide cover, making you and maybe one of those with you almost impossible to find.
- **I've never said that I am done.** You move fast and your weapon moves almost on its own. For remainder of the combat, each time you Attack you can do an additional Gambit without expending a die.

2 Favour Spells.

- **They are within reach.** When you search for somebody you know, you can determine if this person is dead or alive and peek into their thoughts and emotions.
- **Grow my beloved, grow.** You put a new life into potentially dead vegetation with your touch. It grows very fast and obeys your commands. Branches can grapple your enemies, fix objects, and obstruct passage. Without water and soil, it dies soon after you leave, expending all its resources. For example, it takes 10 minutes to make a wooden door frame impassible, but only several seconds to make a wooden door impossible to open. In combat, it immobilizes enemies on the

round of casting and impairs weapons until escape(Vigor Save) on later turns.

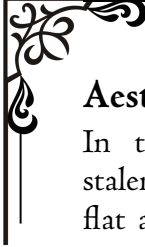
- **It hurts, I know.** Transfer a Trauma from one willing creature to another willing creature of roughly the same consciousness level.
- **Vesna will guide you.** Choose a willing creature, next time they attempt a roll with at least 1 Focus – they roll as if an additional Focus was spent.

3 Favour Spells.

- **There is only a single path.** When you go through a door, you envision another door that you have traversed in the past day. As long as you hold the door open, it leads to the place with that other door you envisioned.
- **Look, we are alike.** You touch a willing animal and assume some of its traits: talons, fins, teeth, fur, etc. You choose what suits you best. You can share these traits with somebody if you keep physical skin contact with them for the whole time. Effect lasts until dismissed.
- **Let me take all the pain.** You touch a willing creature and transfer any one of their Injuries to yourself.

4 Favour Spells.

- **You and me: friends.** You summon an animal to aid you. It understands you when you speak with it, can't speak back, but can transmit emotions and follow simple instructions. You can choose any size as long as it is no larger than a well-fed barn cat. Depending on the size roll for Vigor. Roll 1d1 if its tiny, like a mice, 1d4 for a bird, like an owl, 2d4 for a badger or opossum, d8 for a cat or a small dog. Roll d6 for Clarity and Spirit. Roll d4 for Guard. If it dies you can summon it again after sunset. Its natural weapons allows to attack for a d4 damage. It can perform *Bolster*, *Impair*, *Move* and *Stop* gambits. It has one Severe injury slot.



Aestur, the ravaging spirit

In the beginning there were stillness and staleness. The sky and the earth were solid and flat and iron. The light didn't travel through space but was preserved frozen in one place, and nothing was seen or heard, and nobody was looking and listening. The cosmos got bored of itself.

But even in constant there is a change. A curious atom came into being under the iron sky. It ran and played along the iron folds and collided and fell and gained velocity until the iron started to ring and sing.

And there was a great ramble and great fire. The iron earth collided with the iron sky. Aestus, the ravaging spirit, was born. The havoc ensorcelled it, and Aestus became determined to destroy. With great power, it broke off a mace out of the iron plane and went on a rampage through the universe.

And there were many things born in destruction. Light and sound, sand and water, fire and stars were the sparks of the great rumble. They were destroyed by Aestus in their turn.

But nothing was sufficient to satiate the ravaging spirit. He took a handful of dirt and made beasts, fish and people, who suffered being tossed and crushed.

By now we live, but soon comes the day we perish under the iron mace of the Aestur. No will be spared.

Corrust, a spirit of dwindling

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Sickness & Malady

Venomous Snakebite

There is no antivenom. The only way to survive is to ask a mage for a concoction. Which they will provide, but the treatment warps the body to assume enough features for poison resistance to take hold. Those changes are irreversible.

Your pupils might turn vertical, scale to appear in places where new skin would have grown.

One can find additions to internal mouth structure or lower back growths.

- Once per combat, you spit venom out of your mouth. It is quick and unexpected: add a d8 to your weapon dice.
- Shape of your head slightly changes, so you can't wear rigid headwear if its not custom made for you.

Mocking Sickness

Once, when wounded, you witness that there is no flesh and no blood inside you.

In its place you find only crumbling clay, withered fabric and sawdust. However, despite all the differences, you feel the same. Maybe a bit duller to touch and less pain. At last, you notice that your wounds are not healing.

- You don't lose Vigor. Since when you discover this change in yourself, record Damage you receive that would have been subtracted from your Vigor.
- For each 3 points of Damage accumulated this way treat your maximum Vigor as if it is reduced by 1. When it reaches 0 your body loses structural integrity and dissolves to dust.
- You accumulate Injuries based on Damage received and wither away when you are out of Injury slots.
- You can kinda feel how your insides should be arranged and don't feel much pain, so you can mend yourself from two Injuries during one Long Rest without rolls.

If you find a puppet master that will agree to such outstanding demand, they could try to patch your body to restore its former shape reducing the recorded Damage.

Bloating Infection

Your wound is infected and at some point in your fever induced delirium you met a foreign presence. It asked you to receive a gift.

Fever was gone in a day. Your recovery amazed anybody who has ever seen an infected wound like yours.

You feel the tint of that presence in each movement of your limbs, in each twitch of a mussels, in each breath and sip of water. Numbness, slowness, swelling of legs and arms. Your skin never recovered its natural colour, chest and stomach bloat, your breathing becomes sluggish and with unsettling rocking in lungs.

You move with visible delay and your reaction is impaired. Another day you find another ulcer on your skin, you feel neither pain, nor distress.

- Each time you do Overnight Rest if your max GD is greater than 1 reduce it by 2.
- For each 2 Guard lost this way increase your maximum Vigor by 1, up to 19.
- You ignore Afflictions of Injuries.

Weaving Parasite

Parasite awakes and digs into your body. You feel flash of agony and then its gone. Unnatural motions of muscles and skin are the only evidence of where it is. In a day it reaches your brain and hatches. You can sense more of the arcane than ever before: learn *Detect Magic* spell. However, thoughts become mirky and mind drowns in fog.

You lose 1 *maximum* Clarity and now have a Spellweaving Pool with size of 1 filled with a single d4.

- Each morning you must feed the parasite. After waking up – roll a die from your Spellweaving Pool, lose that much Clarity. Restore 1 spent die from the pool.
- Record total amount of Clarity lost this way. For each 5 Clarity lost – lose 1 *maximum* Clarity, increase pool size by 1 and add an additional d4 to the pool. Permanently Upface it once for each other die in the pool.
- When you have a d12 added this way – parasite is fully matured and stops feeding.

Detached Soul

When your body takes critical damage, instead of succumbing to injuries and pain your soul detaches and continues to fight.

- When you can't allocate a new Injury you don't die. Instead your body collapses and your ghostly form emerges.
- It has 1 Vigor, 0 Armour, but otherwise keeps your parameters. Physical Damage applies to you the same, but targets Spirit instead of Vigor and ignores armour.
- You keep your Traumas, but not Injuries. For damage to Spirit do the same Injury calculations as for Vigor, but receive Trauma instead. If you can't fit a new Trauma – you are **Slain**.
- You can't be grappled, pushed or moved and you can't do the same to interact with objects. So, you can't perform Gambits that require physical interaction. However, you can Bolster just fine.
- You deal damage to Spirit and you can give Trauma if you would have dealt enough damage to cause an Injury. Additionally, ignore armour for Injury and damage calculations.
- You can't use Deny Feat, but gain ability to go through physical objects. There is no limit, but when there is no light you can lose sense of direction and become trapped.
- If your physical body dies – you persist, but it's easier to return back to your own mortal vessel than to find a new one. There are no obvious ways to do either though.

You can choose appearance of your soul and keep two pieces of your gear and one weapon.

Particular Brain Damage

There was a lucky sword strike or a very violent night out. After waking up you realise that the world is different that you remember it. Learn *Detect Magic* spell.

You gain a Spellweaving Pool with two d4 in it. Each time you reach maximum Clarity – roll maximum die in your Spellweaving Pool and lose that much Clarity. You may permanently Upface one die in your Spellweaving Pool.

Split Personality

Your mind overloads with stress, you feel like insanity approaches, but instead of collapse into abyss – your consciousness splits and now you are not just one, but two.

You create another knight that from now on inhabits your body.

- Roll three d12 + d6 and pick two of them and assign to Clarity and Spirit. Determine values of Focus and Stress for your new personality and track these separately from the old ones.
- Decide if they are a Spellweaver, a Witch or neither.
- Both of you still share Vigor, Injury Slots with their contents and Guard.
- Both of you acquire Quirks independently, share corporal illnesses and must switch upon gaining Trauma which are shared between two of you.
- You can willingly switch governing personality by acquiring 1 Stress.
- Pick their Passion and, finally, a name.

Once the splitting event is occurred, you switch to the new personality immediately.

Unsettling Discovery

You can't refill any Spellweaving pool by resting or indulging a passion. If you didn't have a Spellweaving pool before you get one.

Each time you receive damage record the damage die. **Upface** it for each time it was Bolstered. **Downface** it for each point of damage which was reduced by Armour or did reduce Guard instead of Vigor.

Add this die to any of your Spellweaving pools. You add this dice even if your pool is full.

Learn *Detect Magic* spell.

Equipment

Weapons & Armour

Weapons have properties to reflect their behavior.

- **Hefty** weapons require one hand. Only one such item can be wielded at once.
- **Heavy** weapons require both hands
- **Long** weapons are **Heavy** and are Impaired in confined environments.
- **Slow** weapons cannot be used if the attacker has moved this turn.

Melee hefty weapons can be two-handed: add its lowest weapon die to the attack and Downface it.

Common Weapons.

- Simple tools: d6 hefty. (pitchfork, hatchet)
- Long, Slow Tools: d8 long, slow. (staff, logging axe, pick)
- Hand Weapons: d6. (dagger, club, handaxe)
- Hefty Weapons: d8 hefty. (spear, mace, axe)
- Long Weapons: d10 long. (poleaxe, billhook)
- Sling: d4 hefty
- Javelin: d6 hefty

Uncommon Weapons.

- Shortbow: d6 long, slow
- Shortsword: 2d6
- Longbow: d8 slow

Rare Weapons.

- Longsword: 2d8 hefty
- Greatsword: 2d10 long, slow
- Curvebow: 2d6 long, slow
- Crossbow: 2d8 heavy, slow

Armour. Generally, each of three layers of armour gives an additional armour point, up to A4 with a shield. Steel protection is rare, so helms, plates and chainmail are very valuable assets.

- ✗ Coat: A1 (mail, gambeson, flexible armour suitable for general wear or beneath plates)
- ✗ Helm: A1 (kettle, nasal, bucket, coif)
- ✗ Steel plates: A1

Shields. Takes one hand, gives one point in armour, common to find. Does not stack if there are two shields. It has d4 as a weapon die.

Spiked shields turn that die into d6.

Consumables

Remedy.

- ❖ **Sustenance** restores Vigor
- ❖ **Stimulant** restores Clarity
- ❖ **Sacrament** restores Spirit

Provide individual restoration by themselves, but can be shared with Company during Short Rest.

Physic.

- ❖ **Spur** replenishes Focus and restores up to 3 Spellweaving dice
- ❖ **Sedative** removes Stress

Can only be used by a single person.

Medicine.

- ❖ **Painkiller** removes Vigor check from injury treatment. Allows treatment of an additional injury today while in effect. Wears off in an hour.
- ❖ **Hallucinogen** renders knight unable to perform basic tasks for six hours and allows them to fight their inner daemons. For each Trauma roll a Spirit check. After each failed check - corresponding Trauma worsens and changes injury slot to lethal, otherwise its removed and knight receives a Quirk(p.II). Can be taken during sleep.

These also can only be used individually.

Ideas

IDEA: restoring and spending guard

It would be cool to restore or spent guard as a gambit. For example, you use bolster to increase damage, but the opposite of bolstering would increase guard by one. Additionally, it would be nice to spend guard to promote any dice to a gambit, recklessness is worth it sometimes. I think making up the difference between the die and the gambit-value. Could that part be a quirk?

IDEA: Alternative injury mechanic

Everybody gets five injury slots. Those are guarded by d4, d6, d8, d10, d12 respectively. Once you receive damage to Vigor you choose an injury slot to risk: roll corresponding die and if its greater or equal to received damage you avoid the injury, otherwise the injury slot is filled. Record the damage and the die that dealt it on the injury slot, roll and record affliction. During overnight rest roll one guarding die of the occupied injury slot, reduce recorded damage by that amount. If it reaches zero or below - injury is healed. If you guard is less then a maximum that could be rolled on the guarding die - roll it and increase your max GD by the rolled value.

Also, if just getting injury slots is boring – one can roll d4 + d6 + d8 + d10 + d12 and distribute their injuries as one see fit. Optimal configuration, I suspect, would be to have as many d4s as possible, but alas. Trauma just occupies an injury slot and is solved by same mechanic that is used now.

If one would consider even more death-spiraly mechanic, then after healing an injury – die of the healed slot is downfaced.

Dealing with increasing/decreasing injury dice can be a whole area of expertise.

IDEA: Crits on Virtue checks

Crit on a Virtue check is an opportunity to improve. Have three of those there and you can get a revelation.

Like a Quirk, but purely positive. Can they be one time things? Or maybe its pure martial's thing to have these?

Vigor

- you roll with focus if you perform actions that involve balancing
- once per combat, in the end of your turn you can decide to roll d4 and add rolled value to your guard
- if you didn't move on your turn, you attack as if you spent an additional focus
- if you moved on your turn, you can upface one of the attack dice
- You can throw weapons with great effect?
- If you have four knives in your possession you can make a ranged attack with 4d6 damage divided arbitrary between up to four targets.

Clarity

- Choose a weapon and spend an evening tinkering with it: do a clarity check. On success you permanently upface one of its damage dice, on failure – downface one.
- Brew a surprise concoction?
- Next time you shoot, instead of moving you can put an arrow, bolt or other projectile into the ground in front of you. This time you can shoot two times.

Spirit

- Ignore affliction
- Shout a cruse - next attack is impaired if target can hear you and fails spirit check. You can oppose this check with arbitrary amount of Focus.

Hope & Fear

Introduction

It seems that there is very fun thing to do during combat. If your enemy rolls for damage and you spot a 1 on their die - you can claim it after the roll is resolved.

The same goes for you, but then GM claims it for later use. Let's call them hope & fear dice for no particular reason.

The dice sets are both public. Party can use them on their own discretion as a form of advantage.

I would say that you can add them to rolls the same way you can use Focus. Maybe before it. That complicates combat, maybe its too much.

TODO: There is a problem there that it's not clear what this pool represents outside of combat.

RESOLUTION: I like the idea that, after the combat finishes, knights convert these dice to Focus, but GM keeps them. Otherwise they can just roll them as an addition to their attack as weapon dice. One roll per participating knight. However, that makes overpowered knights even more busted.

TOOD: There is a problem that this mechanic actually disgorges using weapons with a lot of dice. There is no benefit to from rolling a maximum value on a die that would counteract fear accumulation.

RESOLUTION: I have an idea about weapon mastery that you can obtain after using it for a while. When you roll a maximum value on a die of a particular weapon – mark it. If you have as many marks as the maximum value of the largest die of the weapon – you get mastery over it. For each level of master you can leave one die that came from Focus or Stress instead of removing it after the roll.

RESOLUTION 2.0: Party has their hope die pool, you can claim a die from there any time to restore one Focus or to roll it as an addition to your attack. You add a die there if the enemy rolled 1 or if you rolled die's maximum. You can have any die there, but d20 can be used only in Virtue checks.

After the fight is over those dice disappear, but before that you can use them to refill Focus. or to mark Experience of knight's weapons.

However, if knight rolls 1 – the die goes to fear pool. And that does not go away. The Referee can use those in later events to represent vulnerability of the party.

RESOLUTION 3.0: You can treat fear as stress budget of whoever is adversarial to the party.

Accumulation and usage

However. Those might be preferable to actual Focus & Stress mechanics as they promote interparty communication.

It would be interesting to see how limits for each rolls will shape that system. The obvious setup is to have limit of 1 when you are using those dice in rolls.

Interestingly, it kinda blends spellweaving pool and attack rolls by tying it to hope & fear system.

Maybe its a bad thing actually.

Combat is not very long, so it might be the case that it's never possible to accumulate too big of a pool. Hoarding behaviour from players also need to be considered though.

That will make this system to be more daggerheart-shaped. Need to look more how it plays then.

Initiative passing

There is also a question about initiative passing. I like the idea that it is governed by fear & hope mechanics as that ties the flow of combat to particular dice rolls.

However, as for now, in Mythic Bastionland there is no meaningful initiative as all members of two fighting parties make turns together.

There could be mechanics for keeping the initiative, but that might be too powerful to introduce.

Technically, during each party's turn there is a cycling through attack targets that might be interesting to explore.

Downtime Activities

I like the idea of giving downtime tokens to knights for them to spend them on treating wounds, healing injuries, reducing stress, restoring focus and brewing(?) consumables.

Brewing

Should I allow knights to brew stimulants and other consumables?

Crafting magical items with essences?